

The Digital World

A Round-up Of Technology News From Across The Globe

CANADA

In conjunction with Ice Wireless of Inuvik, Northwest Territories, Canada, the Cambridge-based Vanu Inc. plans to deploy GSM in Canada's extreme northern region, bringing cellular phone service to remote Canadian communities in an geographically enormous operating area.

ISRAEL

India's hegemony in BPO is facing a new challenge - with Israeli high-tech companies developing their own programming centres and hiring hundreds of women for cheap and quality labour.

CHINA

MorganStanley analysts very recently released a report that listed the top 10 trends in China. The number 3 trend was that China Internet is mobile-centric rather than PC-centric. China is currently #1 in the world in mobile subscribers and #1 in Internet users under the age of 30.

SOUTH KOREA

Korea will be developing combat robots. At the government's tenth annual meeting of science and technology ministers on September 20, the Defense Ministry and the Ministry of Information and Communication decided to co-operate to develop a "dog/horse" military robot.

GERMANY

The 2006 World Cup will feature cutting-edge technologies such as a ubiquitous wireless network, radio tags and video-on-the-go services. IT firm Avaya will take charge of hooking up the event to the Net in collaboration with Deutsche Telekom.

SINGAPORE

The recent arrest of three Singaporeans accused of making racial slurs on Internet message boards has sparked concerns of a cyberspace crackdown by authorities in Singapore and Malaysia, where strict laws suppress outspokenness. Bloggers there now fear they'll have to watch their words.



Stewart Butterfield, who co-founded Flickr with wife Caterina Fake, though, has moved to soothe fears.

He said users and the new owners were all on the same side, and that the team just could have done a much better job in communicating what all this meant.

Yeah, right! First they sell out and then ask everyone to be calm. It's an age-old problem.

It's the community that made the site—and yet, neither the creators nor the buyers thought it necessary to include the community in this process.

Of course, Yahoo! 360 is not yet as popular, and this could perhaps change that.

Or maybe it could just all go wrong for Yahoo!. Only time will tell. As for the community, they are still fighting.

PODMANIA

Apple Roks Again!

Putting an end to months (maybe years) of speculation, Apple finally unveiled their new range of products including a new iPod - the Nano - and the much-awaited iTunes phone, the Motorola ROKR. At an event in late September in San Francisco, Apple CEO Steve Jobs surprised attendees by introducing a completely new addition to the iPod line that will replace the iPod mini. The wafer-thin iPod Nano sports a colour screen and can hold a thousand songs in a form factor slimmer than a pencil.



Three Incredibly Useful Sites

News And Views

www.worldnews.com



WorldNews

This is essentially a search engine for news sites. Sites listed range from Kashmir News to London Globe. In the middle of the page are the day's headlines and breaking news. You can search the WorldNews network as well. The site may seem a little disorganised, but that's just because of the sheer amount of content!

www.slate.com



Slate

Slate has a lot on its plate! There's something for everyone-news, politics, arts, lifestyle, business, tech, health, science-and much more. The great thing about Slate is that there are so many well-written articles in every category. It's definitely a must-visit every week, if not every day.

www.oneworld.net



OneWorld.net

For the sheer breadth of global news, Oneworld.net can't be beat. There's in-depth coverage of major news stories as well as news that doesn't make it to the TV or elsewhere. Oneworld.net sports a clean design and intuitive interface which offers more than enough information to satisfy the most demanding news junkie. There are topic guides, country guides and lots more.